

Second Session Video Reflection

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Author Note

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I have no known conflict of interest to disclose.

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Video Submission: Second Session

Skills

Before the video begins, the Liberty 505 students and I discuss their goals for the session. They define the skills they were assigned to practice, and we decide together that challenging/confrontation will be the focus of this session. The other skills they previously concentrated on are mentioned as areas that need to continue to develop. In this part of the interaction, I was trying to encourage the students to form their own goals and watch for their own competencies.

As these students are new to counseling terminology and counseling skills, most of what I did in this session (and other sessions) was teaching about the skills and teaching when to use the skills. You can see this teaching in action with each of the reflective segments at 12:51, 13:45 where I was teaching how to use paraphrasing, 31:15 where I was delineating empathy and the difference between immediacy and confrontation, 32:43 where a student had a question about immediacy, 49:50 where the topic of challenging clients came up, 105:54 where the need to be present was a learning moment for all, 107 where difference between leading and open-ended questions came up and, 108:50 where I was offering new language for challenges and goals.

Another skill I wanted to utilize in this, and all sessions was reflecting. Specifically reflecting where I saw the skills they were practicing. When someone points out an intentional move on my part, it cements the skill in my repertoire. I felt the same would be true for these students. You can see this happening in the video at 13:24, pointing out skills, 29:00 skills listing, 49:22 skills used in the practice and encouraging the skill of challenging as he was the first to use this skill, 51:49 and 106:50, where I simply walked back through what I saw in their run-through.

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Validating these students seemed like an important part of these meetings. I remember what it was like to lack confidence and trust in the process. I always try to speak life into what they are doing, and that is present in this video at 12:51, where I encourage her to be present, 28:54, and 105:31, where I encourage her to be present and stay out of her head.

However, although validation and encouragement are important, challenging students to improve or to notice where they may be lacking skills is equally important. I tried to challenge these students at 13:40 to use other skills besides what flows from conversational styles, at 50:55 to use empathy before a challenge, and at 106:39 to turn statements into questions in this video.

Socratic questioning is a method of supervision I want to try and use more often. I was able to work in some questions in this video at 14:59 and 29:58, where I turned the lesson back on the student rather than simply saying what I saw. This leads to other areas of improvement I saw in the video.

Improvements

First, I took a lot of the students' time in each of these three meetings. I want to improve by taking less time to reflect on each interaction. I could easily point out one or two skills and improvements for each student and allow the next student to begin their practice. Again, I could always add more opportunities for questions, teaching by questions, and less talking. Perhaps there is a way to start each reflection with a question before I dive into talking about what I saw.

Overall, this was a successful supervision I am content with.